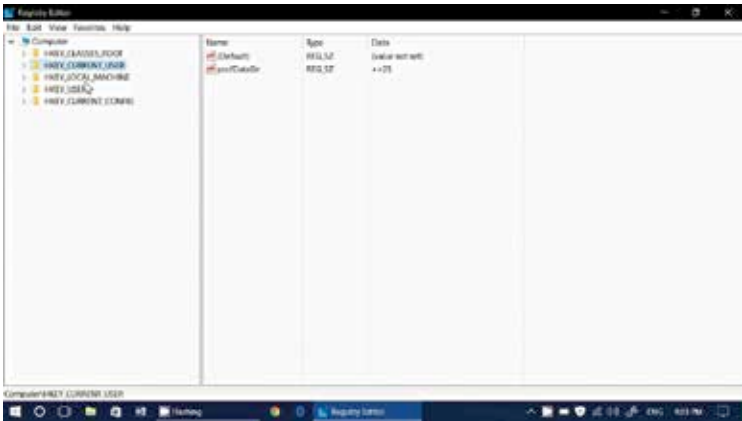




The Windows Registry

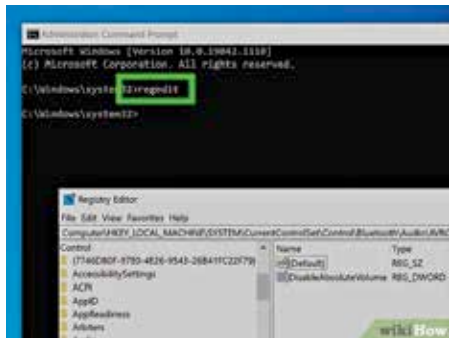
The Windows Registry isn't required for all Windows apps. Some programs use XML or other types of files instead of the registry to store their configurations, while others are completely portable and store their data in an executable file.

Accessing the Windows Registry

The Registry Editor tool, a free registry editing utility included by default with every version of Microsoft Windows dating back to Windows 95, is used to access and configure the Windows Registry.

Registry Editor isn't an application that you can install on your computer.

Instead, use the `regedit` command from the Command Prompt or the search or Run box from the Start menu to get to it. The Registry Editor is the public face of the register, and it allows you to view and edit it, but it is not the registry itself. In technical terms, the registry refers to a collection of database files in the Windows installation directory.



Opening the Registry Editor